

GlowMart

Product Safety and Ingredient Guide

Our Safety Standards

Every product sold at GlowMart meets or exceeds FDA cosmetic safety guidelines. We work exclusively with brands that conduct dermatological testing, clinical efficacy studies, and provide full ingredient transparency on packaging and online. GlowMart does not sell products containing parabens (methylparaben, propylparaben, butylparaben), formaldehyde or formaldehyde-releasing preservatives, hydroquinone, phthalates, or coal tar. All products are tested for heavy metal contamination (lead, mercury, arsenic, cadmium) and must fall below our thresholds, which are stricter than FDA requirements. We conduct annual audits of all brand partners to verify compliance with our safety standards.

Organic and Clean Beauty

Approximately 25 percent of our product catalog is certified organic by USDA or COSMOS standards. Organic products are made with ingredients grown without synthetic pesticides, herbicides, or GMOs. Look for the organic badge on product pages and shelf labels. Our clean beauty selection goes further, excluding over 50 controversial ingredients including sulfates (SLS/SLES), synthetic fragrances, mineral oil, petrolatum, talc, and BHA/BHT. Clean beauty products are clearly marked with a green leaf icon in-store and online. Our proprietary Clean Beauty Standards are reviewed annually by an independent toxicologist to reflect the latest safety research. Note that clean and organic are different designations: a product can be clean but not organic, and vice versa.

Ingredient Glossary

Understanding common skincare ingredients helps you make informed choices. Hyaluronic Acid: A humectant that holds up to 1000x its weight in water, attracting and retaining moisture for plump, hydrated skin. Found in serums, moisturizers, and sheet masks. Retinol (Vitamin A): Promotes cell turnover, reduces fine lines, evens skin tone, and treats acne. Available in concentrations from 0.25 to 1 percent. Requires sun protection. Niacinamide (Vitamin B3): Brightens skin, reduces redness, minimizes pores, and strengthens the moisture barrier. Well-tolerated by most skin types at 5-10 percent. Salicylic Acid (BHA): A beta-hydroxy acid that is oil-soluble, penetrating into pores to unclog them. Best for oily and acne-prone skin at 0.5-2 percent. Vitamin C (L-Ascorbic Acid): An antioxidant that brightens, protects against free radical damage, and supports collagen synthesis. Most effective at 10-20 percent in a low pH formula. Peptides: Short chains of amino acids that signal the skin to produce more collagen, improving firmness and reducing wrinkles. Ceramides: Lipids naturally found in the skin barrier that prevent moisture loss and protect against environmental damage. Glycolic Acid (AHA): A water-soluble alpha-hydroxy acid that exfoliates the surface of the skin, improving texture, brightness, and fine lines. Centella Asiatica (Cica): A plant extract with anti-inflammatory and wound-healing properties, excellent for sensitive and irritated skin.

Allergen Information

All products at GlowMart include complete ingredient lists on packaging and on our website product pages.

Common allergens in beauty products include fragrances (both natural and synthetic), lanolin (derived from sheep wool), certain preservatives (methylisothiazolinone, formaldehyde releasers), essential oils (tea tree, lavender, peppermint), and colorants (carmine, certain FD and C dyes). If you have known allergies, always check the full ingredient list before use. Our beauty advisors can help identify products suitable for sensitive or allergy-prone skin. We recommend patch-testing any new product by applying a small amount to the inner forearm and waiting 48 hours before applying to the face. Customers with latex allergies should note that some beauty sponges contain latex. Our website offers an ingredient search tool where you can filter products by excluding specific ingredients.

Expiration and Storage

Beauty products have shelf lives. Look for the Period After Opening (PAO) symbol on packaging, shown as a small jar icon with a number and M (e.g., 12M means 12 months after opening). General guidelines: Sunscreen should be replaced annually regardless of remaining product. Mascara and liquid eyeliner should be replaced every 3 months due to bacterial growth risk. Liquid foundation lasts 6-12 months after opening. Cream products (blush, eyeshadow) last 12-18 months. Powder products last 18-24 months. Lipstick lasts 12-18 months. Skincare serums with active ingredients (vitamin C, retinol) last 6-12 months. Unopened products with no PAO symbol are generally good for 3 years from manufacture date. Store all products in a cool, dry place away from direct sunlight. Discard any product that changes in color, texture, smell, or separates.

Cruelty-Free Commitment

GlowMart prioritizes brands that do not test on animals. Over 60 percent of our catalog is certified cruelty-free by Leaping Bunny or PETA. Look for the cruelty-free badge on product pages and shelf labels. We are actively working to increase this percentage annually as part of our ethical sourcing commitment. Note that cruelty-free does not automatically mean vegan. Vegan products contain no animal-derived ingredients (no beeswax, lanolin, carmine, collagen, keratin, or silk). Approximately 35 percent of our catalog is both cruelty-free and vegan, marked with a separate vegan badge. We support brands that invest in alternative testing methods including in-vitro testing, computer modeling, and volunteer human patch testing.

Pregnancy-Safe Products

Many customers ask about product safety during pregnancy and breastfeeding. Ingredients generally recommended to avoid during pregnancy include: retinol and all retinoids (including prescription tretinoin), high-dose salicylic acid (above 2 percent, though low-dose in cleansers is generally considered safe), hydroquinone, chemical sunscreen filters (oxybenzone, avobenzone), and certain essential oils (rosemary, sage, juniper). Safe alternatives include: bakuchiol instead of retinol, glycolic acid or lactic acid for exfoliation, azelaic acid for acne and brightening, mineral sunscreen, and fragrance-free formulations. Always consult your OB-GYN or dermatologist about your specific routine. GlowMart associates can help identify pregnancy-safe alternatives for every step of your routine.

Regulatory Compliance

GlowMart complies with all applicable US federal and state regulations for cosmetic products, including the FDA Fair Packaging and Labeling Act, the FD and C Act, California Proposition 65, and the EU Cosmetics Regulation 1223/2009 for products also sold in Europe. All products display complete ingredient lists using

INCI (International Nomenclature of Cosmetic Ingredients) naming conventions. Products making specific claims (SPF protection, anti-acne, anti-dandruff) are classified as over-the-counter drugs and undergo additional FDA review and registration. Our quality assurance team tests random product samples quarterly for label accuracy, contamination, and stability.